

American Kenpo

Belt requirements

Ed Parker's system — 9 ranks, 154+ techniques, 8 forms

Prepared for EntrenaDojo

Belt progression overview

Belt	Kyu	Min. time	Classes	Techniques	Forms	Sets
Yellow belt	9th Kyu	2-3 months at White	24	10	Short Form 1	Blocking Set 1, Striking Set 1
Orange belt	8th Kyu	3-4 months at Yellow	36	16	Long Form 1	Blocking Set 2, Finger Set 1
Purple belt	7th Kyu	4-6 months at Orange	48	18	Long Form 2	Coordination Set 1, Stance Set 1
Blue belt	6th Kyu	4-6 months at Purple	60	20	Short Form 2	Coordination Set 2, Stance Set 2
Green belt	5th Kyu	6-9 months at Blue	72	20	Long Form 3	Finger Set 2
3rd Brown belt	4th Kyu	6-9 months at Green	90	16	Long Form 4	Two-Man Set (partner drill)
2nd Brown belt	3rd Kyu	6-9 months at 3rd Brown	100	16	Long Form 5	Two-Man Set extension
1st Brown belt	2nd Kyu	6-12 months at 2nd Brown	120	4	Long Form 6	Club Set, Knife Set
1st Black belt	Shodan	12-18 months at 1st Brown	150	4	Long Form 7, Long Form 8	Final sets to examination standard



Yellow belt (9th Kyu)

10 techniques · 1 form · 24 classes min

Minimum time 2-3 months at White	Classes required 24	Sparring No sparring required
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Self-defense techniques

1. Delayed Sword (front right-hand lapel grab)
2. Alternating Maces (front two-hand push)
3. Sword of Destruction (front left straight punch)
4. Deflecting Hammer (front right front kick)
5. Capturing the Storm (overhead right club attack)
6. The Grasp of Death (left flank right-hand headlock)
7. Checking the Dark (front right step-through punch)
8. Mace of Aggression (front two-hand lapel grab, pull)
9. Attacking Mace (front right step-through punch)
10. Sword and Hammer (right flank, right-hand shoulder grab)

Forms / katas

- Short Form 1

Sets

- Blocking Set 1
- Striking Set 1



Orange belt (8th Kyu)

16 techniques · 1 form · 36 classes min

Minimum time 3-4 months at Yellow	Classes required 36	Sparring Point sparring introduction (light contact)
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Self-defense techniques

1. Lone Kimono (front left-hand lapel grab)
2. Glancing Salute (front right-hand direct push)
3. Five Swords (front right step-through roundhouse punch)
4. Scraping Hoof (full nelson)
5. Grip of Death (left flank headlock)
6. Crossing Talon (front right-hand cross wrist grab)
7. Triggered Salute (front right-hand direct push)
8. Dance of Death (front right step-through straight punch)
9. Thrusting Salute (front right step-through straight punch)
10. Locking Horns (front headlock)
11. Evading the Storm (front right step-through overhead club)
12. Parting Wings (front two-hand push)
13. Hugging Pendulum (front right thigh tackle)
14. Repeating Mace (front left step-through punch)
15. Charging Ram (front tackle)
16. Crash of the Eagle (front right-hand lapel grab)

Forms / katas

- Long Form 1

Sets

- Blocking Set 2
- Finger Set 1



Purple belt (7th Kyu)

18 techniques · 1 form · 48 classes min

Minimum time 4-6 months at Orange	Classes required 48	Sparring Controlled point sparring required
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Self-defense techniques

1. Twisted Twig (front left wrist lock)
2. Snapping Twig (front left-hand push)
3. Leaping Crane (front right step-through punch)
4. Swinging Pendulum (front right roundhouse kick)
5. Thundering Hammers (front right step-through punch)
6. Squeezing the Peach (rear bear hug, arms free)
7. Calming the Storm (front right roundhouse club)
8. Darting Mace (front right step-through punch)
9. Hooking Wings (front two-hand low push)
10. Shield and Sword (front right step-through punch)
11. Striking Serpent's Head (front bear hug, arms pinned)
12. Locked Wing (rear hammerlock)
13. Obscure Wing (front right-hand shoulder grab)
14. Reversing Mace (front left step-through punch)
15. Buckling Branch (front right step-through kick)
16. Raining Claw (front right uppercut punch)
17. Crashing Wings (rear bear hug, arms pinned)
18. Bow of Compulsion (front wrist lock against right punch)

Forms / katas

- Long Form 2

Sets

- Coordination Set 1
- Stance Set 1



Blue belt (6th Kyu)

20 techniques · 1 form · 60 classes min

Minimum time 4-6 months at Purple	Classes required 60	Sparring Continuous point sparring, 2-minute rounds
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Self-defense techniques

1. Sleeper (front right step-through straight punch)
2. Circling Wing (rear two-hand choke, arms bent)
3. Gathering Clouds (front right straight punch)
4. Destructive Twins (front two-hand choke, pulling)
5. Broken Ram (front tackle)
6. Circling the Horizon (front right step-through right punch)
7. Menacing Twirl (front right-hand chest push)
8. Encounter with Danger (front two-hand grab to wrists)
9. Detour from Doom (front right roundhouse kick)
10. Securing the Storm (front overhead right club)
11. Begging Hands (front two-hand grab to wrists)
12. Thrusting Prongs (front bear hug, arms free)
13. Fallen Cross (rear two-hand choke)
14. Returning Storm (front right-hand club, inward)
15. Crossed Twigs (rear two-hand grab to wrists)
16. The Back Breaker (front right step-through punch)
17. Flight to Freedom (rear hammerlock)
18. Entangled Wing (front arm lock)
19. Conquering Shield (front left stiff-arm lapel grab)
20. Defying the Storm (front right roundhouse club)

Forms / katas

- Short Form 2

Sets

- Coordination Set 2
- Stance Set 2



Green belt (5th Kyu)

20 techniques · 1 form · 72 classes min

Minimum time 6-9 months at Blue	Classes required 72	Sparring Semi-free sparring, 3-minute rounds
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Self-defense techniques

1. Clipping the Storm (front right step-through overhead club)
2. Flashing Wings (front right step-through punch)
3. Unfurling Crane (front right and left punch combination)
4. Bowing to Buddha (front right roundhouse kick)
5. Reversing Circles (front left step-through punch with arm grab)
6. Tripping Arrow (front bear hug, arms free)
7. Spiraling Twig (front wrist lock)
8. Rotating Destruction (front right step-through punch)
9. Entwined Lance (rear bear hug, arms pinned, lifted)
10. Mace of Aggression (front two-hand lapel grab, push)
11. Circling Destruction (rear left-hand club)
12. Captured Leaves (front right-hand finger lock)
13. Obscure Claws (front left-hand choke)
14. Leap of Death (front right step-through punch)
15. Protecting Fans (front right and left punch combination)
16. Destructive Fans (front right and left punch combination)
17. Fatal Deviation (front right-hand push then punch)
18. Twisted Fate (front two-hand push, follow-up)
19. Clutching Feathers (front left-hand hair grab)
20. Glancing Wing (front right-hand shoulder grab)

Forms / katas

- Long Form 3

Sets

- Finger Set 2



3rd Brown belt (4th Kyu)

16 techniques · 1 form · 90 classes min

Minimum time 6-9 months at Green	Classes required 90	Sparring Free sparring, multiple attackers introduction
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Self-defense techniques

1. Charging Ram (front tackle, variation)
2. Leaping Crane (front right step-through punch, ext.)
3. Twisted Twig (front wrist lock, ext.)
4. Dance of Darkness (front right step-through straight punch, ext.)
5. Marriage of the Rams (front offset headlock)
6. The Ram and the Eagle (front tackle)
7. Dominating Circles (front right step-through punch, ext.)
8. Destructive Kneel (front right step-through kick)
9. Crossing the Dark (front right step-through punch, ext.)
10. Escape from the Storm (front right club attack, ext.)
11. Prance of the Tiger (front right and left punch combination)
12. Flashing Mace (front right step-through punch, ext.)
13. Hugging Pendulum (front right thigh tackle, ext.)
14. Brushing the Storm (front right overhead club, ext.)
15. Captured Twigs (rear full nelson)
16. Swinging Pendulum (front roundhouse kick, ext.)

Forms / katas

- Long Form 4

Sets

- Two-Man Set (partner drill)



2nd Brown belt (3rd Kyu)

16 techniques · 1 form · 100 classes min

Minimum time 6-9 months at 3rd Brown	Classes required 100	Sparring Free sparring, weapon defense drills
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Self-defense techniques

1. Unfurling Crane extension
2. Bowing to Buddha extension
3. Reversing Circles extension
4. Tripping Arrow extension
5. Spiraling Twig extension
6. Rotating Destruction extension
7. Entwined Lance extension
8. Circling Destruction extension
9. Captured Leaves extension
10. Obscure Claws extension
11. Leap of Death extension
12. Protecting Fans extension
13. Fatal Deviation extension
14. Clutching Feathers extension
15. Glancing Wing extension
16. Destructive Fans extension

Forms / katas

- Long Form 5

Sets

- Two-Man Set extension



1st Brown belt (2nd Kyu)

4 techniques · 1 form · 120 classes min

Minimum time 6-12 months at 2nd Brown	Classes required 120	Sparring Free sparring, graded rounds, weapon defense required
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Self-defense techniques

1. All prior technique extensions refined
2. Original technique creation (2 required)
3. Freestyle technique adaptations (8 minimum)
4. Spontaneous technique demonstration

Forms / katas

- Long Form 6

Sets

- Club Set
- Knife Set



1st Black belt (Shodan)

4 techniques · 2 forms · 150 classes min

Minimum time 12-18 months at 1st Brown	Classes required 150	Sparring Free sparring exam (3 rounds), weapon defense, multiple attackers
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Self-defense techniques

1. All 154 named techniques and extensions
2. 24 original techniques (thesis requirement)
3. Freestyle self-defense against all attack categories
4. Multiple attacker defense (3 opponents)

Forms / katas

- Long Form 7
- Long Form 8

Sets

- All prior sets to examination standard

American Kenpo belt requirements based on Ed Parker's system. Prepared for EntrenaDojo, June 2026.